

'Play Ball' Time Opens For Miners

EL PASO — Ask Andy Cohen what type baseball team he will have this spring and, no doubt, he will leave the scene quicker than butter melts over an open flame.

Check the U.T. El Paso roster and one might discover the Miners will have proven hitting but lack of depth on the mound.

Cohen gets his first look at his team under fire this weekend when the University of New Mexico comes in for a three - game series. Friday's single game, at Dudley Field, starts at 2 p.m. The double dip Saturday is slated for 1 p.m.

Seven of the top eight hitters from the 1967 outfit—which kept opposing pitchers as nervous as wounded duck on the desert—return as well as the two leading chunkers.

Only Larry McFarlin, a fly chaser - infielder, is gone from Cohen's 1967 team which put together a 25-12-1 record while compiling a staggering .326 team batting average.

Righthander Jesse Lujan and Lefty Lynn Hunt each won eight games last season. Hunt, the most often used twirler, had a 8-3 record with a sparkling 1.73 ERA while Lujan posted an 8-1 mark with a 4.12 ERA.

Cohen figures to be stronger than a wrestler's eyebrows behind the plate this season with the addition of Ronnie Hix, a JC import. Cohen feels so sure Hix can handle the job he has dispatched Charlie West to the outer garden.

West was behind the plate last season and had a .366 batting average. With Hix, a 185 - pounder from Dallas, showing more signs of relieving the catching chores than a bird dog on point, West can return to the duties of chasing flies.

Besides West, such sluggers as Danny Blanco (.355), Robert Aguirre (.344), Juan Sandoval (.339), John Miller (.336), John Murphy (.327) and Ron Rush (.303) are back for the 1968 season.